

Build Your AI Second Brain

A step-by-step setup guide using 4 Claude Code skills.
Drop this PDF into Claude Code and it sets everything
up for you.

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01

What is this system and why it works

Most people consume a lot. YouTube videos, tweets, Instagram reels, blog posts. Good ideas everywhere. But a week later, almost none of it is accessible. It just disappears.

This system fixes that. Every piece of content you find interesting gets captured, processed, and saved as a structured note in Obsidian. Permanently. Searchable. Connected to everything else you have ever saved.

The system is built on Zettelkasten: one note per idea, every note linked to related notes. Knowledge does not pile up in folders, it forms a network. The more you add, the more useful it becomes.

Four Claude Code skills handle all the heavy lifting. You paste a link. Claude reads it, extracts the ideas, and writes the notes. You never touch a text editor.

What gets captured

YouTube videos, Instagram reels, Instagram carousels, blog posts, articles, tweets, research papers, anything with a URL. One command per source. The rest is automatic.

Where it lives

A folder on your machine: `~/knowledgebase/`. Point Obsidian at it and your second brain is live. Three subfolders: `dump/` for raw content, `notes/` for atomic concepts, `index.md` as the connection map.

02

The 4 Claude Code skills that power it

CORE SKILL

knowledgebase

The engine. Paste any URL and Claude fetches it, extracts distinct ideas, writes one note per concept, and updates the connection map.

- Works with blogs, papers, tweets
- One note per idea, not per source
- Links related notes automatically
- Trigger: "add this to kg [URL]"

MEDIA SKILL

youtube-transcribe

Paste a YouTube URL and Claude extracts the full transcript using yt-dlp. Pipe it straight into the knowledgebase to save the ideas as notes.

- Works with any public video
- Extracts timestamped transcript
- Handles long videos cleanly
- Trigger: "youtube transcript [URL]"

MEDIA SKILL

instagram-carousel

Paste an Instagram carousel URL and Claude downloads every slide and extracts all visible text using vision. Feeds directly into the knowledgebase.

- Reads every slide in order
- Extracts all text via vision
- Works on public posts
- Trigger: "instagram carousel [URL]"

MEDIA SKILL

instagram-transcribe

Paste an Instagram reel URL and Claude transcribes the audio using Whisper. The transcript is then saved to your knowledgebase as structured notes.

- Audio-to-text via Whisper
- Works on reels and short videos
- Saves ideas, not just raw text
- Trigger: "transcribe this reel [URL]"

All 4 skills are free and open source. The knowledgebase skill is a plugin. The media skills are standalone. They all write to the same folder so everything stays connected.

03 + 04

Setup and daily workflow

1 Install the knowledgebase plugin

Open Claude Code and run: `/install knowledgebase`

2 Install the 3 media skills

Run: `/install youtube-transcribe-skill`, then `/install instagram-carousel`, then `/install instagram-transcribe`

3 Create your vault

Tell Claude: "Set up my knowledgebase at `~/knowledgebase` with the Zettelkasten structure."
Claude creates `dump/`, `notes/`, and `index.md`.

4 Connect Obsidian

Open Obsidian, add `~/knowledgebase` as a new vault (or as a subfolder of your existing one).

5 Start capturing

That is it. The system is live.

You find something interesting

→ YouTube, reel, carousel, blog, tweet

Paste the link into Claude Code

→ "add to kg", "youtube transcript", "transcribe this reel"

Claude processes it

→ fetches, transcribes, extracts ideas

Structured note saved to Obsidian

→ linked to everything else you have ever saved

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